minority students, fell to Rs 250 crore from last year's Rs 741 crore. Welfare should not be determined by religious identity, the government argued, adding that earlier allocations did not reflect actual expenditure. Critics fear the reductions will disproportionately affect communities already facing socio-economic disadvantages.

In Kolkata's Jyoti Nagar Colony, disruptions in the drinking water supply even prompted Mamata Trinamool Congress's Rajya Sabha MP Samirul Islam to write to the United Nations Human Rights Office on October 9, alleging targeted discrimination because the local residents did not vote BJP. BJP MLA Ritesh Tiwari publicly denied any communal intent, citing the underlying land ownership of the Kolkata Port Trust and the sub-judice status of the colony's encroachment case. Independently unverified, the incident highlights the ambient tension and fears over the treatment of minorities.

Much has been spoken, under the BJP, about who should celebrate Durga Puja. There was a serious attempt to brand it as a strictly Hindu religious occasion. The CM mandated that no non-Hindu worker be allowed to participate in the immersion processes. The Adhikari government maintains its policies are guided by legality and equal treatment. For minorities, that formulation is being tested in more ways than one in everyday lived realities. ■

Takeaways

- **Bengal logs 46 hate crimes against Christians under BJP rule so far, across 13 districts**
- **Incidents include raids on churches, private prayers; some include assault**
- **Besides physical security, Muslims also face structural disempowerment via policy**



CRACKED SOIL A farm with Adani Power tower in Charan Tungi village, Jamnagar district

ON THE EVENING OF SEPTEMBER 17, Prime Minister Narendra Modi's birthday, Gujarat witnessed a rare sight. Farmers in Jetpar village of Morbi burnt his effigy along with that of Union home minister Amit Shah. Stranger still, it's not just the Opposition Congress or independent farmers' bodies that are backing the protesters. Leading them from the front, in the BJP's own Patidar heartland, are a state minister's brothers. The RSS-affiliated Bharatiya Kisan Sangh (BKS), too, is sympathetic to their cause.

That cause has a cause: the Khavda Hybrid Renewable Energy Park, the Adani group's flagship project, slated to be the world's largest of its kind, aiming to generate 30 gigawatts from solar panels and wind turbines. Its plan to integrate with the national grid rests on a 765 kV double-circuit transmission line running 246 km from a pooling station at Khavda in Kutch to a new switching station at Halvad in Morbi, which falls in Saurashtra. That line cuts through 400 villages in Kutch and Morbi, with thousands of farmlands en route.

For the past four months, affected farmers in parts of Saurashtra have been staging a protest against what they are getting in return for ceding space on their farms. The compensation model here shifts from the Land Acquisition, Rehabilitation and Resettlement (LARR) Act of 2013 because the farmer keeps the title—even continues paying land revenue. Transmission lines are merely laid